



Samsung's first non-Samsung phone

Samsung launched its Galaxy A6s in China which is not made by Samsung but by a Chinese company Wintech. <https://digit.in/nov-18-35-1>



Facebook set-top box

Facebook is reportedly building a TV set-top box with a built-in camera optimized for Facebook Watch. <https://digit.in/nov-18-35-2>

Google Pixel 3 64GB

Compact with a fantastic camera



The Google Pixel 3 is the successor to last year's Pixel 2. Is it a worthy upgrade?

Build and design

Sleek and attractive are the first things that come to mind when you first see the Pixel 3. The smartphone has a 5.5-inch display and it fits comfortably in one hand. It has a compact form factor with a unique implementation of the glass back. We have seen something similar on the Silk White OnePlus 6, but in this case, it feels different. The absence of a notch is appreciated along with the ergonomic nature of the smartphone. The only downside is the absence of any face recognition technology which feels like a missed opportunity, especially in 2018.

Display and sound

The display definitely has the potential to go toe-to-toe with the new iPhones and the offerings from Samsung, if not surpass them when it comes to performance. The touch response of the display is fantastic too. It responds to the slightest touch and typing with one hand or both hands was a breeze on the smartphone.

Moving to sound, you have a stereo setup on the smartphone with both the speakers facing you which is how we like it. The sound from the speakers is really loud, clear and you can huddle around the phone in a relatively noisy café to enjoy a movie trailer. For calls, the audio is loud, clear and at 70 percent volume, it's loud enough to hear well.

Performance

On paper, 4GB RAM doesn't seem like much and this shows in the benchmark performance when compared to the S9+, Note 9 and the



Price
₹71,000



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iPhone XS. However, real-world performance is a different

story. Games ran perfectly smooth with little load times. Multitasking was a breeze and switching between over two dozen open apps was no problem. Animations are swift, apps open almost instantly,

games run without any glitches, there is really nothing we can tell you about the performance that has a significant drawback in real-world scenarios. It can go toe-to-toe with the performance of any flagship on offer today.

Camera

Google has taken its fantastic camera and ensured its performance has been updated. There is zero shutter lag no matter what the lighting condition when taking a photo.

Top Shot is a fantastic feature. Portrait mode here works like it did on the Pixel 2. A single rear dual-pixel camera and a lot of software (AI) is

used to get some fantastic bokeh effects. It is a lot better than those found on some dual-camera devices. Regular shots from the rear camera are rich in details, clear and sharp. In well-lit conditions, you get some fantastic photos with absolutely clear details. Even in low-light conditions, the camera's performance is fantastic with low noise and good detail retention.

Moving to the front camera, you have two 8MP shooters here. The purpose is to give you a wide angle when clicking selfies. While the wide-angle camera works well for selfies, the only downside is that a detailed inspection of the selfies reveals softening of blemishes on the skin like the beauty mode found on other smartphone cameras.

Battery life

Another area where the Pixel 3 impresses is with the battery life. You can easily run the device for a work day with little gaming and video content consumption among other daily activities of calling, messaging, social networking and more. However, super heavy users who keep full brightness, have the display always on and are absolute workhorses, may not like the battery life.

Verdict

The Pixel 3 brings with it a refinement to a known design, butter smooth performance, a pixel perfect camera and a display to immerse you. For the asking price, it is more affordable than an iPhone XS and offers fantastic overall performance. Sure, there is no face unlock and at full volumes the entire device vibrates but if you want flagship performance, then you can absolutely consider it.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 5.5-inch | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: FHD+ (2160 x 1080p) | DISPLAY PROTECTION: Corning Gorilla Glass 5 | WEIGHT: 148 grams | BATTERY: 2915 mAh | CPU: Snapdragon 845 | RAM: 4 GB | STORAGE: 64/128 GB | REAR CAMERA: 12.2 MP | FRONT CAMERA: Dual 8 MP

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